★ BUCK-FIFTY INNOVATION LABS COMICS GROUP ★

OCT 1996 • ISSUE #1 • $1.50 US

SUBJECT #13

64-BIT BLAST EDITION!

THE COMPLETE 14-MODE SUBTERRANEAN SAGA!

ARTSY 2000: THE $1.50 BREAKOUT!

FEATURING: THE SPHERE • SURGERY ("JUST LET GO") • THE RISE • LABYRINTH • EDGE HYPERCUBE • PARKING STEALTH • PIZZA SPRINT!



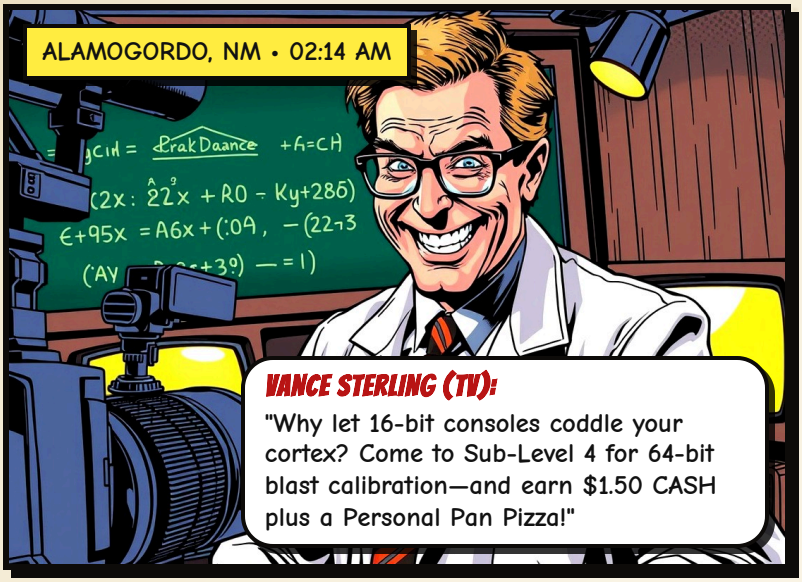
FREE INSIDE!
ALL 14 GAME MODES & TERMINAL INTERROGATION SURVIVAL SECRETS!

DIRECT SUB-LEVEL 4

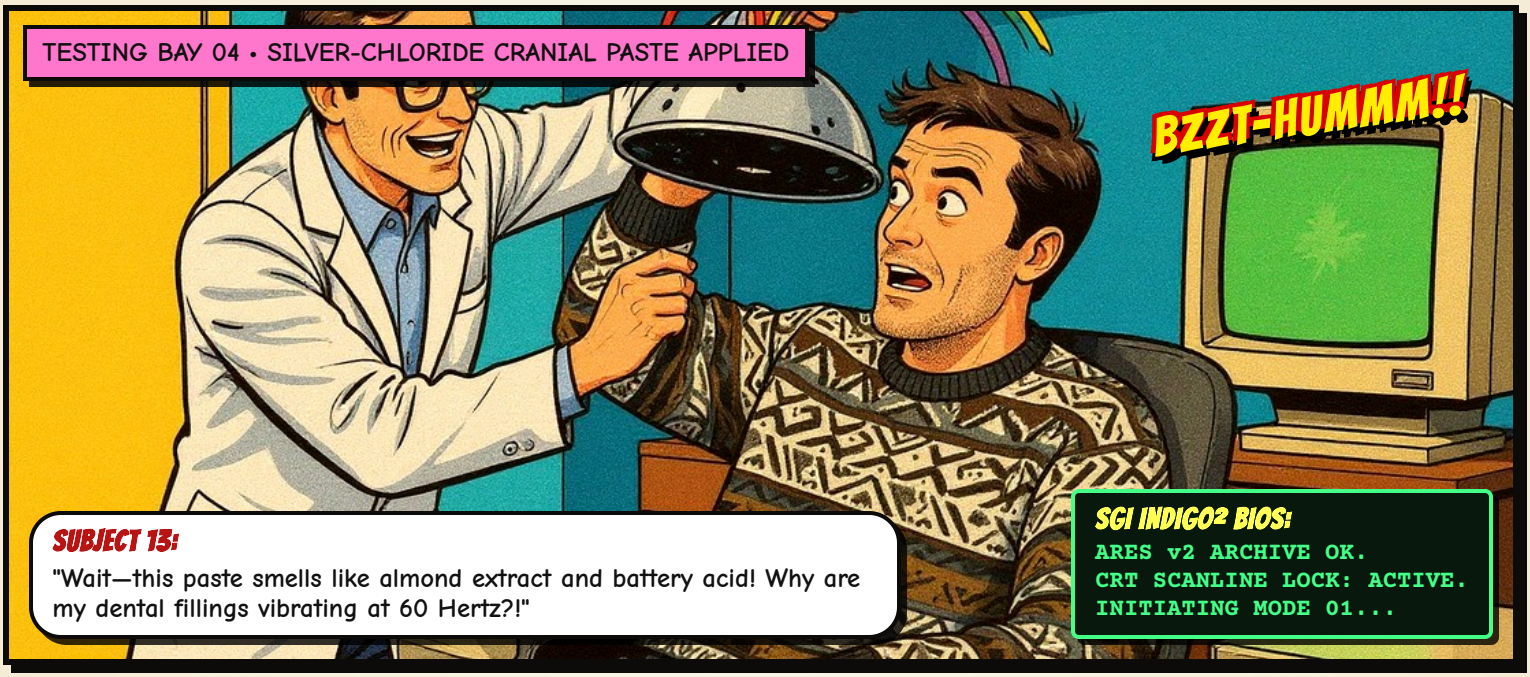
7 19960 00150 3 • 00111

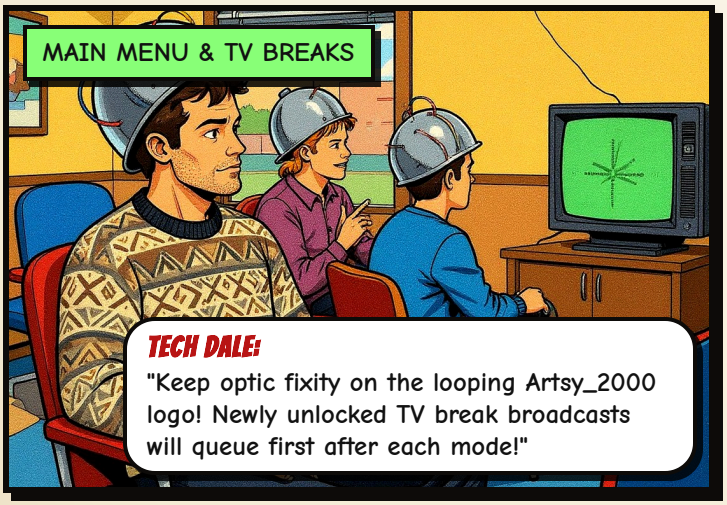
"THEY PROMISED ME $1.50 AND A PERSONAL PAN PIZZA..."

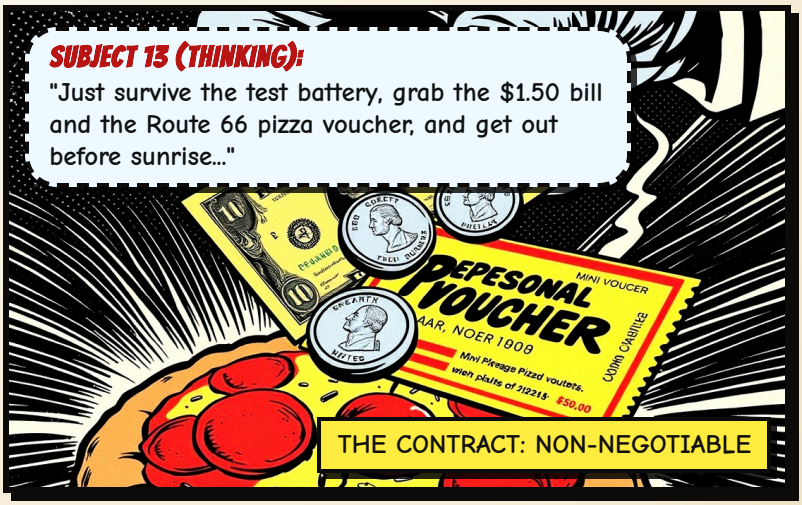
Instead, Founder Vance Sterling strapped a colander telemetry helmet onto my head and plugged me into an SGI Indigo² 64-bit blast pipeline! Now Subject 13 must outwit 4 terminal interlocutors, escape Exam Room 04 with his brain still safely in his head, and conquer 14 wild test modes!







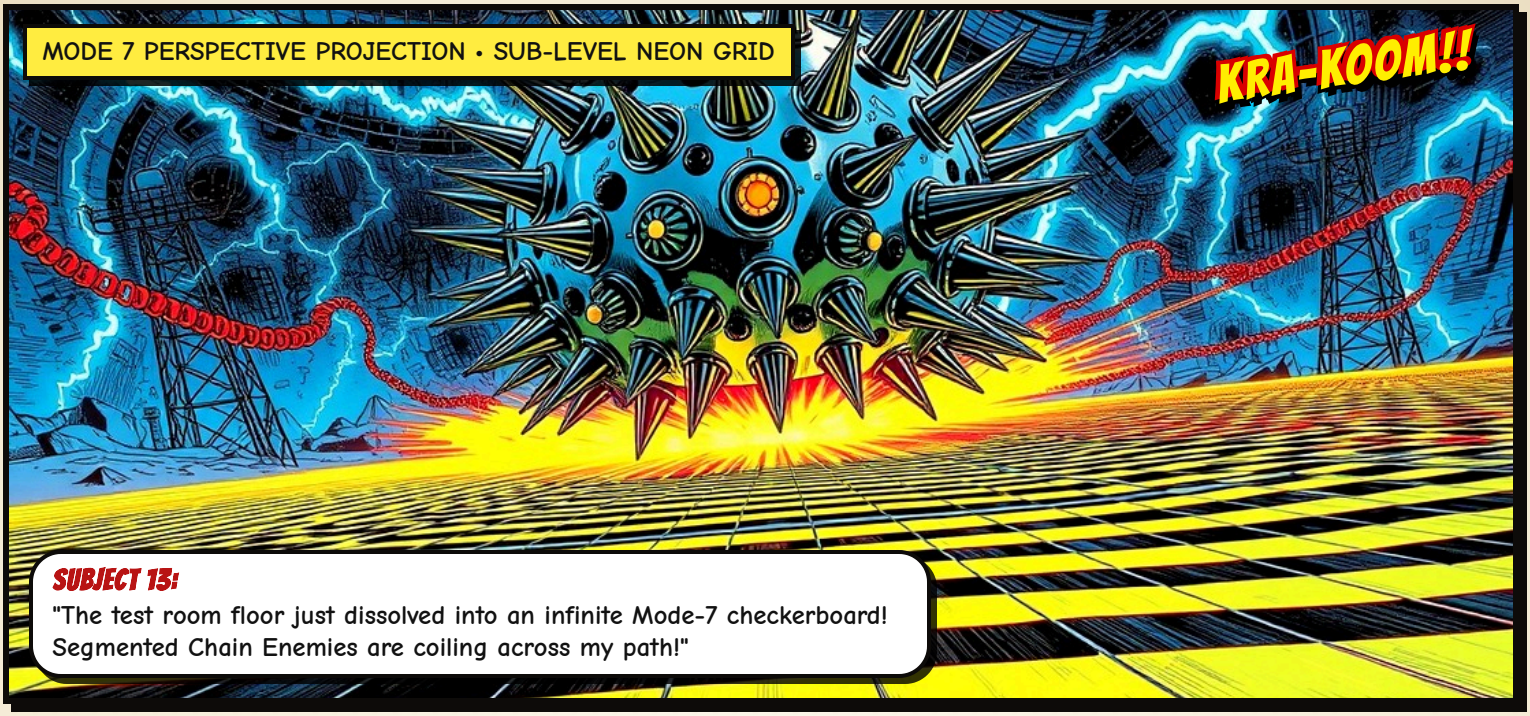


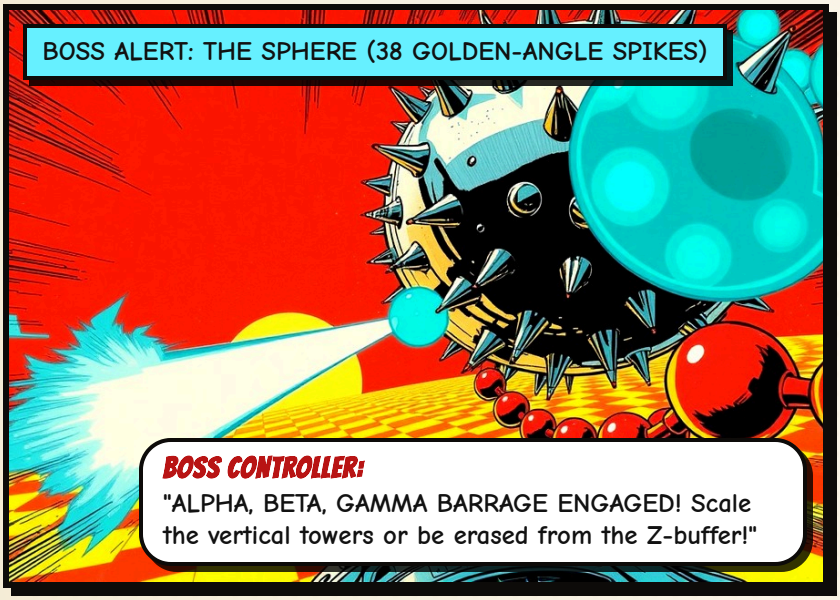


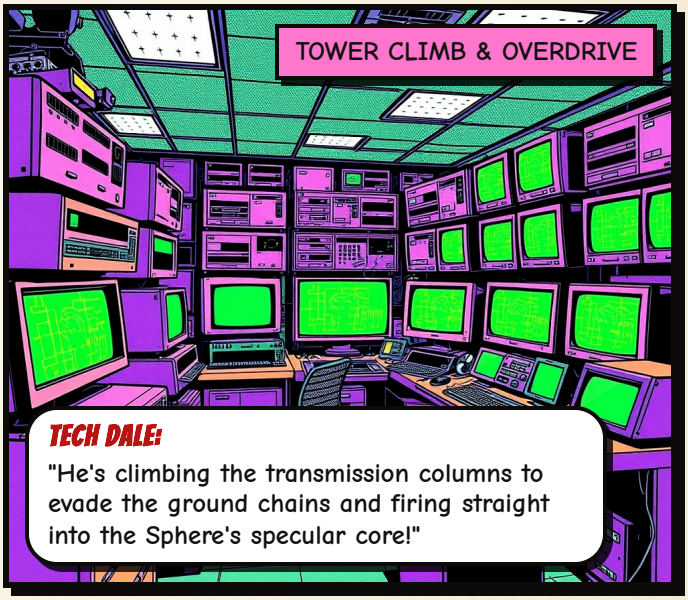
PHASE 00: BOOT & MENU
BootLoadingState → FmvVideoState → MainMenuState

GAMEPLAY MODES AVAILABLE
Standard Campaign, SpeedRun (300s Hourglass), Permadeath, & Relive Trauma Training.

TV BREAK PERMUTATION
Newly unlocked FMVs prioritized in current permutation order.







CRITICAL CORTICAL SPIKE DETECTED!

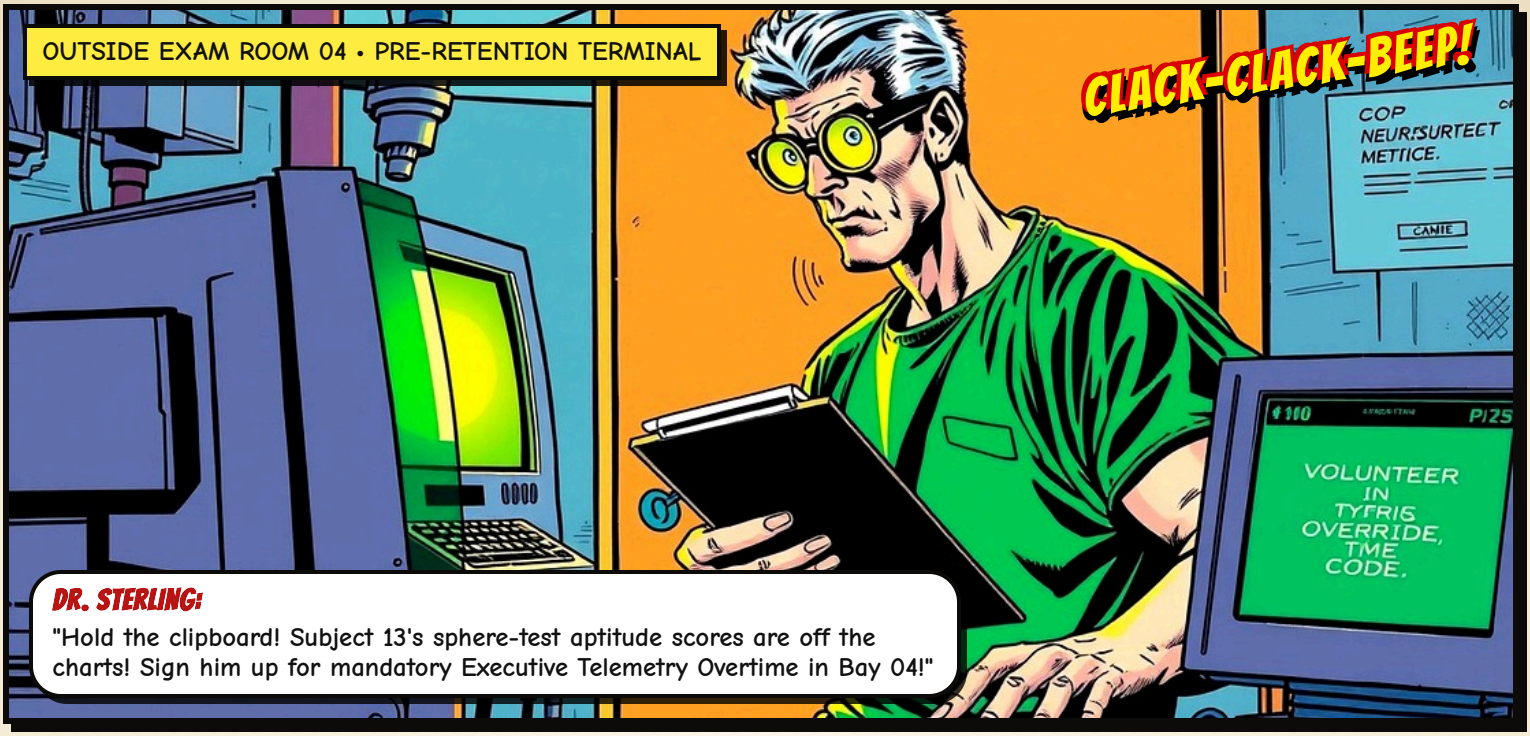
As the 38-spike chrome boss shatters across the horizon, Subject 13's score skyrockets past the baseline threshold. In the observation booth, amber status lights begin to flash: this volunteer's 64-bit spatial reflexes are far too profitable to let him clock out after a single shift!

```
[CHASE TELEMETRY]
• Ground: Row-striped CPU Mode-7
• Enemies: ChainEnemy + Towers
• Boss: 3-Phase Fibonacci Sphere
• Next: Pre-Op Intake Bay 04
```

MODE 01: CHASE
WorldManager + BossController + GroundRenderer

CORE MECHANICS
Steer across the 3D horizon, destroy segmented chain enemies, climb towers, and defeat the Spiked Sphere Boss.

DISTORTION & RETRIES
Tracks retry count & real-time post-processing filters.





EXAM BAY 04 • DIALOGUE INTERROGATION LOG

To clear PreOpQuiz, Subject 13 must exploit Dr. Sterling's constant bureaucratic distractions—rattling carts, pager memos, and CRT glare:

> **WINNING PROTOCOL:** Log a compliant cortical baseline while secretly routing the local table cuffs to an unmonitored diagnostic channel!

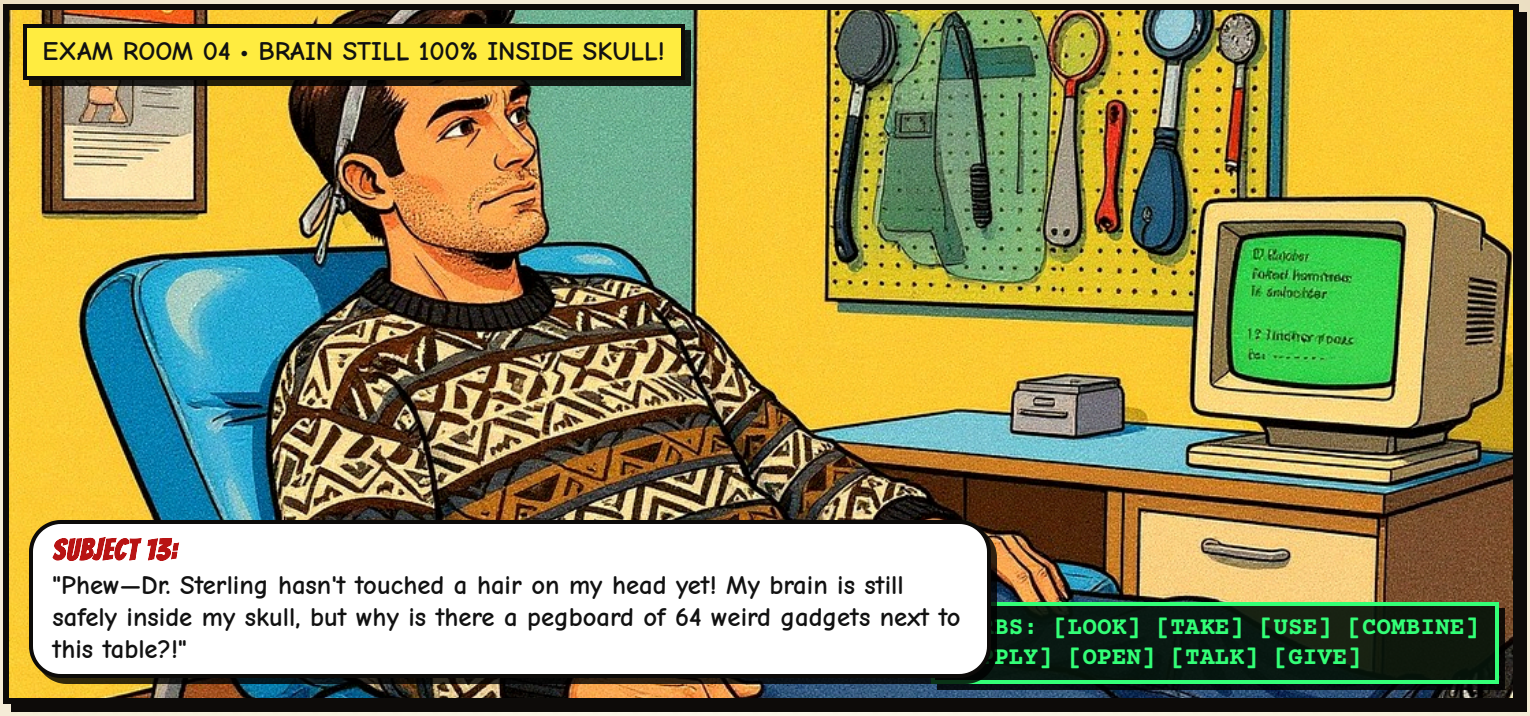
> **ROOKIE MISTAKE:** Answering with Dadaist nonsense (pouring espresso into the flyback transformer or removing eyebrows with a mayonnaise jar) trips the conditioning alarm!

90-SECOND WINDOW UNLOCKED! Fooled by the spoofed baseline, Dr. Sterling leaves the exam room console unlocked for 90 seconds to hunt for his spare glasses and espresso mug!

MODE 02: PRE-OP QUIZ
Conversation / PreOpQuiz State

INTERROGATION STRATEGY
Spoof compliant neuro-telemetry & reroute table cuffs while Dr. Sterling steps out.

UNLOCKED TV BREAK
tv_break_medical_officer.mp4





POINT-AND-CLICK DECOY VS. ESCAPE

On the surface, SurgeryState presents a satirical 1990s LucasArts/Sierra-style adventure interface with 3D raytraced directional arrows and 64 eccentric medical tools designed to keep panicked volunteers clicking until Dr. Sterling returns.

SECRET KEYBOARD ESCAPE SEQUENCE:

J U S T L E T G O

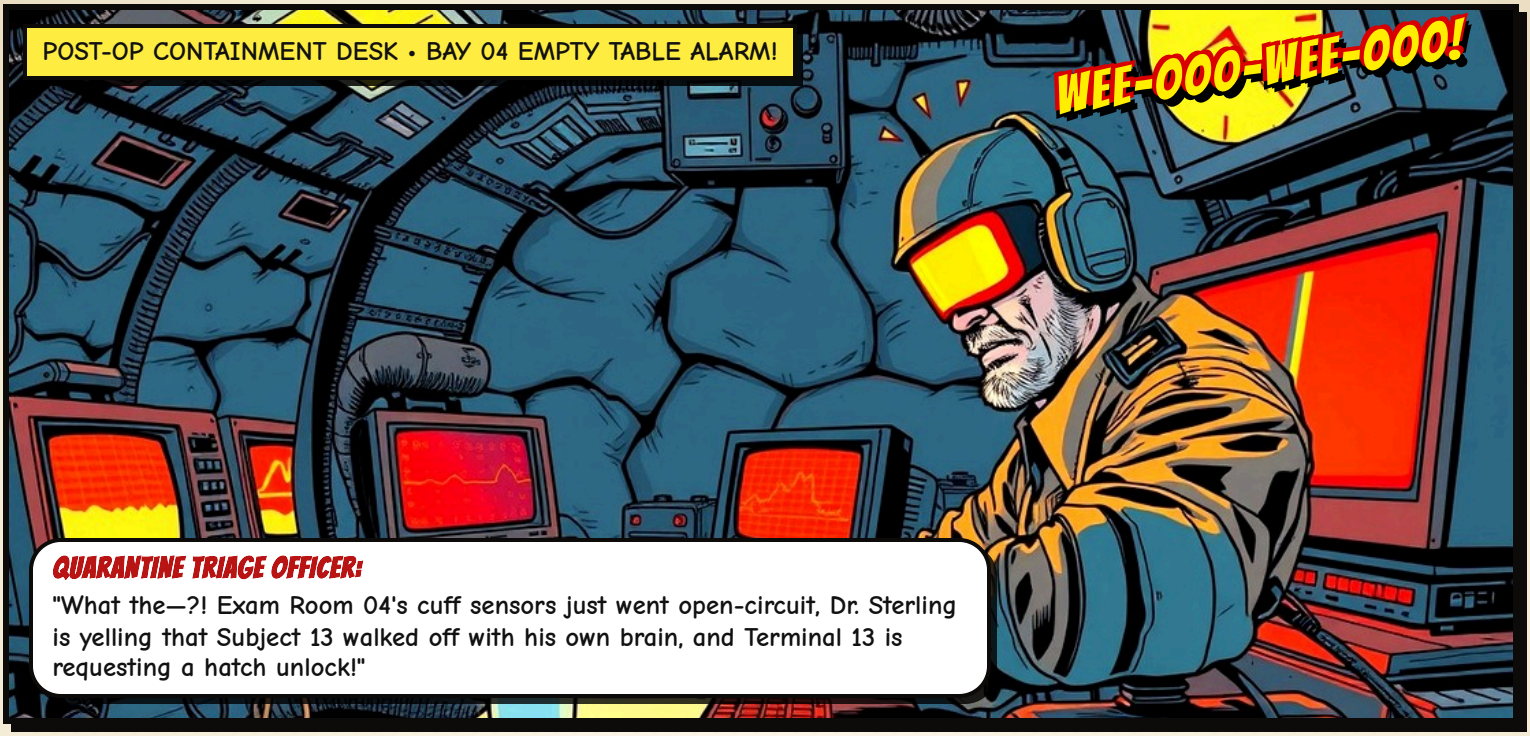
(Floating hint letters alternate missing chars & prefix chars at 50% alpha)

As the final "O" is typed, the magnetic wrist cuffs pop open! Subject 13 hops off the exam table—brain still 100% un-extracted—and slips out the service hatch!

MODE 03: SURGERY
SurgeryState ("Just Let Go")

DUAL LAYER DESIGN
8 adventure verbs + 64 decoy tools + secret floating-letter keyboard escape (`JUST LET GO`) before any extraction occurs.

RELIVE TRAUMA
Directly playable from the Main Menu & Debug Bar.





QUARANTINE TELEMETRY LINK • CONTAINMENT BYPASS

In TriageQuiz, the exhausted night-desk officer has three consoles blinking red at once. He desperately wants an excuse to clear his screen:

> WINNING PROTOCOL: Tag your hallway terminal ping as a scheduled post-op phantom echo, a transducer zeroing cycle, or an automated calibration test!

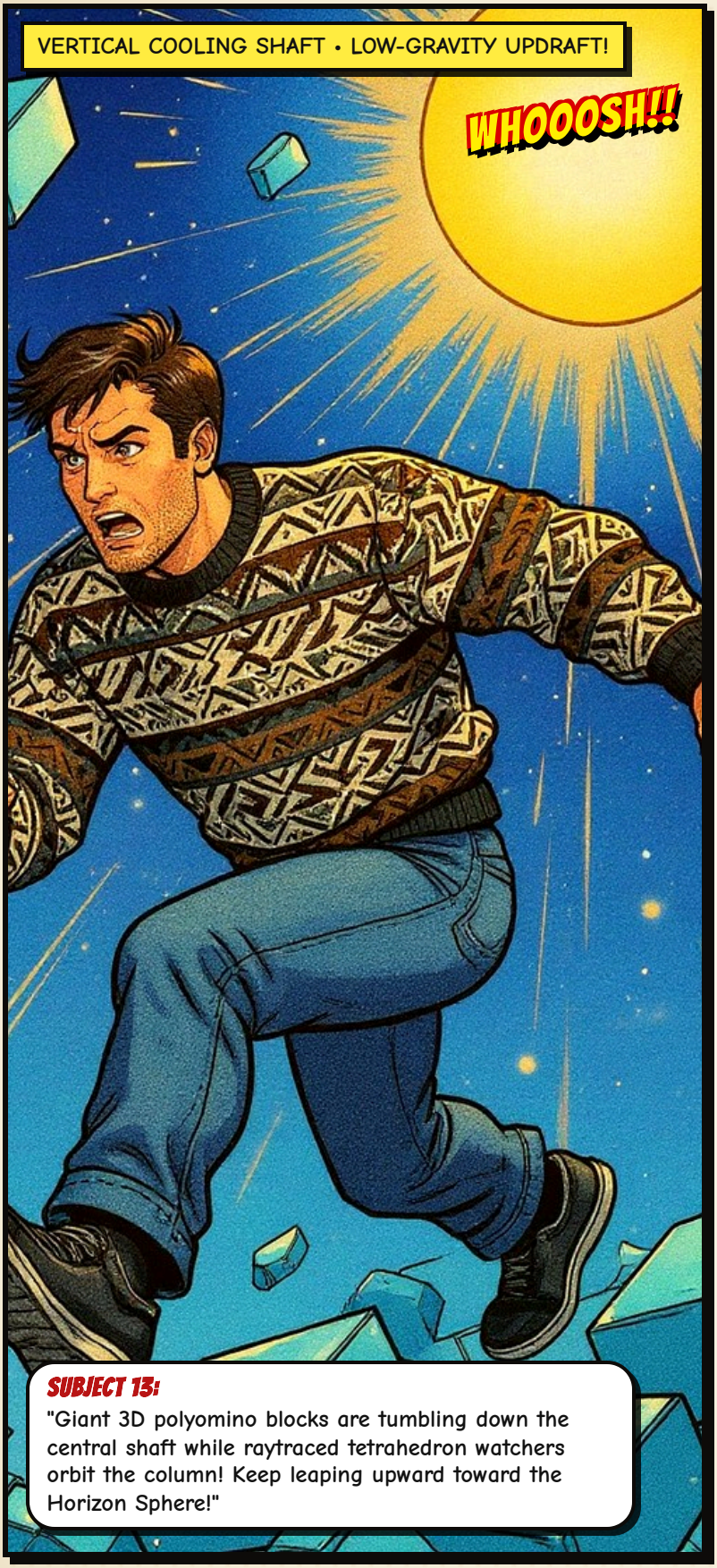
> RESULT: Mutters *"classic Buck-Fifty spaghetti telemetry"* and flips the heavy industrial toggle unlocking the hatch into the Vertical Cooling Shaft!

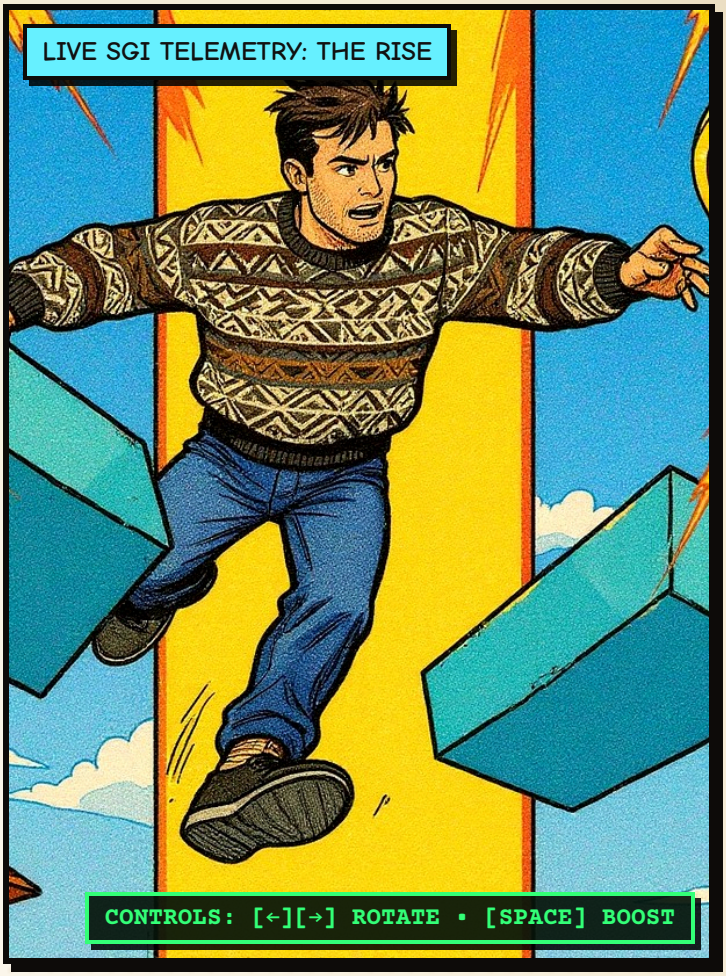
CLUNK! The cooling-shaft airlock unlatches! Subject 13 leaps into the low-gravity updraft column!

MODE 04: TRIAGE QUIZ
Conversation / TriageQuiz State

INTERROGATION STRATEGY
Disguise your corridor terminal ping as routine phantom telemetry to unlock The Rise shaft.

UNLOCKED TV BREAK
tv_break_triage_officer.mp4





POLYOMINO BALLISTICS & RAYTRACED WATCHERS

- I-BAR (CYAN): Narrow, high-speed vertical springboard.
- O-BLOCK (YELLOW): Heavy resting ledge; sinks rapidly.
- T-SPIKE (MAGENTA): Erratic center of mass; avoid outer tips.
- L-HOOK (ORANGE): Snags on shaft walls—pinch hazard!

HORIZON SPHERE BREACHED! Using **RiseScoreTransfer**, Subject 13 vaults into the upper ventilation matrix!

MODE 05: THE RISE
RiseState (Interactive CPU Raytracer)

CORE MECHANICS
Climb the central column across falling polyominoes past rotating tetrahedron watchers to reach the Horizon Sphere.

SCORE TRANSFER
RiseScoreTransfer → Labyrinth





[LABYRINTH TELEMETRY HUD]
1st-person perspective wireframe walls rendered at 60Hz with live cardiac ECG waveform monitoring. Sprint the neon corners before tunnel vision sets in!

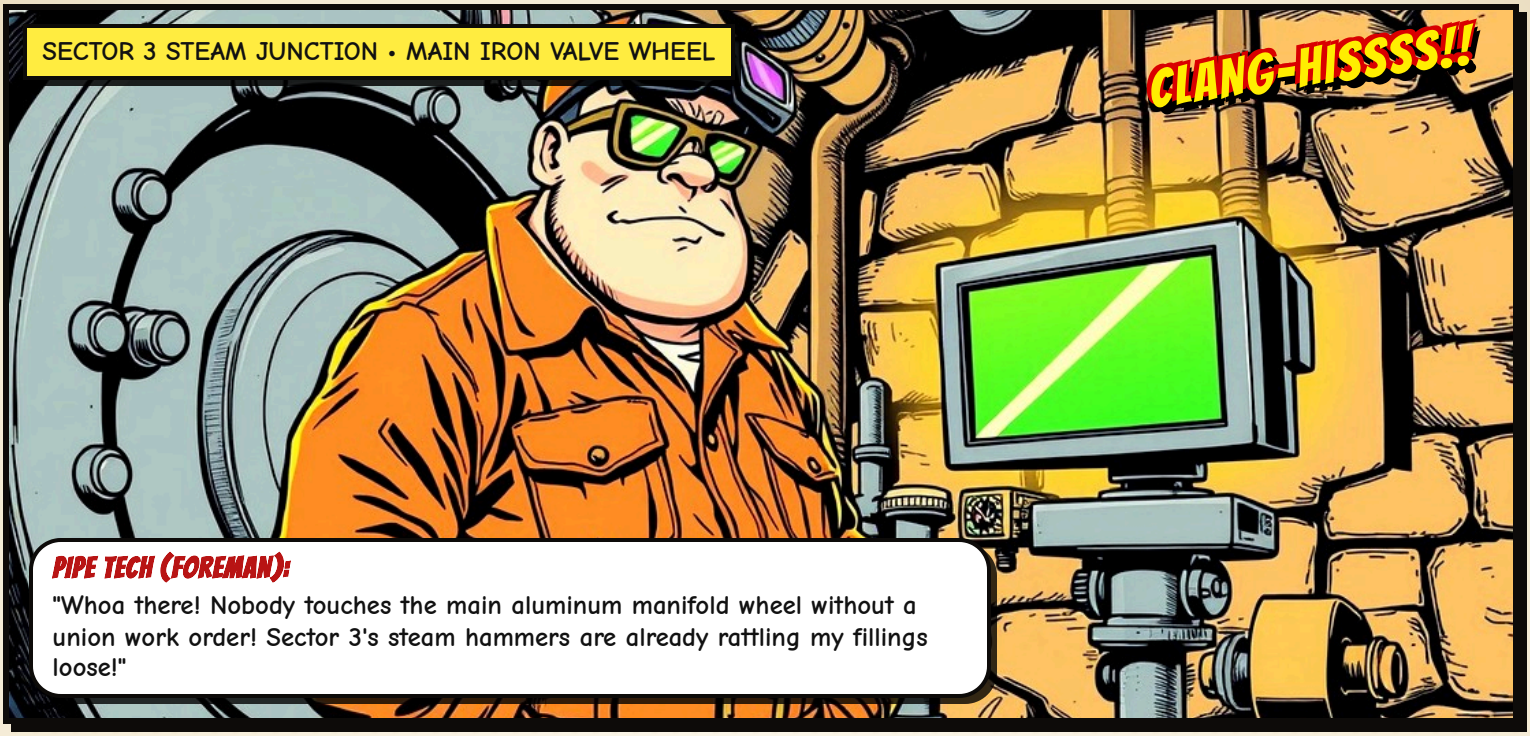


[G-FORCE STOMACH FLIP EVENT!]
Sudden vector deceleration triggers acute 60Hz rollercoaster vertigo and stomach-flipping motion sickness! Only emergency saltine crackers—or ducking into the Sector 3 steam manifold—can settle equilibrium!

MODE 06: THE LABYRINTH
LabyrinthState + ECG Vitals HUD

CORE MECHANICS
1st-person emerald wireframe maze traversal with cardiac vitals tracking and G-force motion-sickness feedback.

NEXT CHECKPOINT
Sector 3 High-Pressure Manifold





HIGH-PRESSURE MANIFOLD CONSOLE • UNION BYPASS

Guarding the hatch between *The Labyrinth* and *Edge Mode*, this grumpy 20-year night-shift veteran follows one sacred rule: "Fewer valves I have to inspect tonight, the better."

> WINNING PROTOCOL: Request a pressure-relief inspection across the three primary manifold keys or a scheduled nocturnal condensation purge!

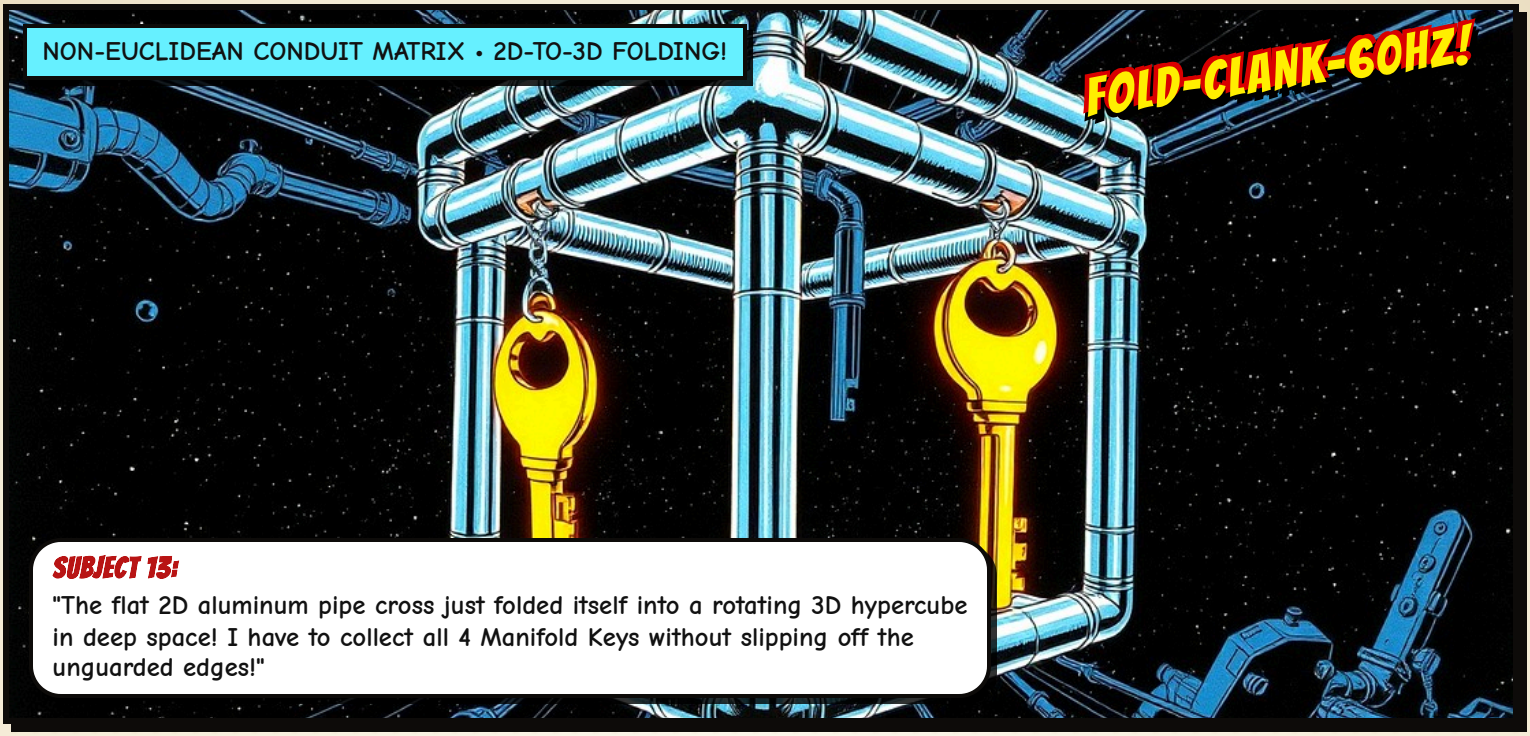
> UNION HAZARD: Watch your step—there are zero OSHA guardrails on the 3D aluminum hypercube!

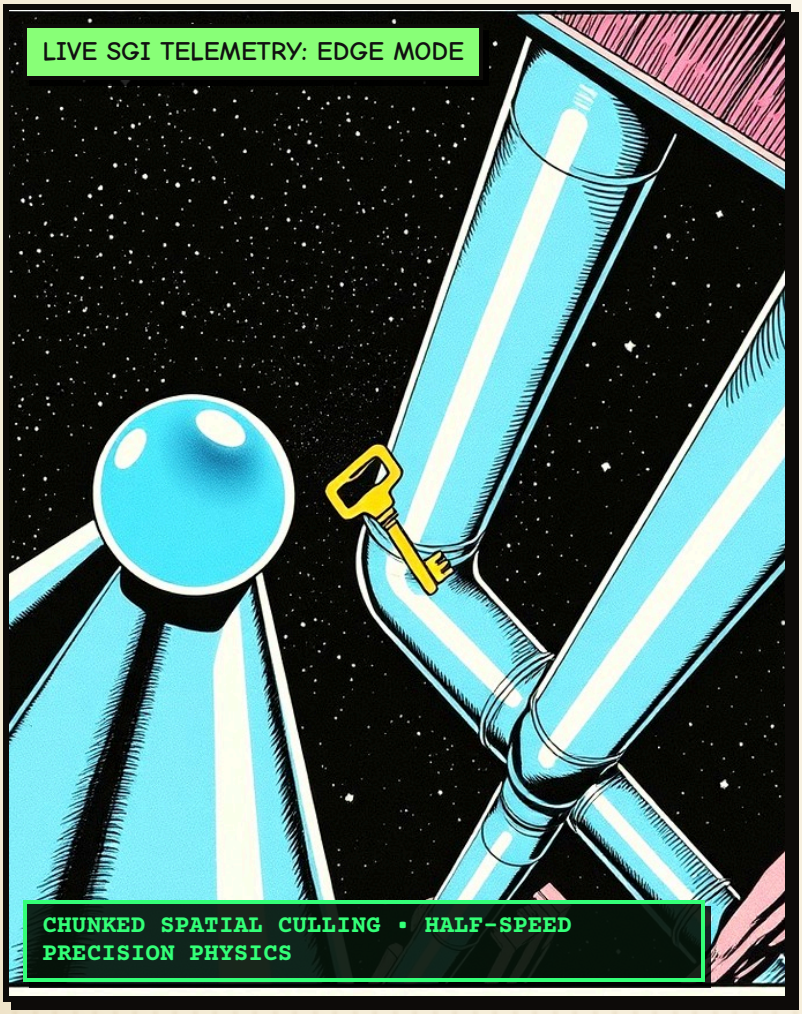
SCREEEE-CLANK! The foreman spins the iron wheel and unseals the manifold trunk into the 3D Aluminum Pipe Hypercube!

MODE 07: MAINTENANCE QUIZ
Conversation / MaintenanceQuiz State

INTERROGATION STRATEGY
Cite union-compliant manifold key inspections to unseal the trunk hatch into Edge Mode.

UNLOCKED TV BREAK
tv_break_conduit_worker.mp4





HYPERCUBE NAVIGATION PROTOCOL

EdgeState combines the spatial chunk culling of *Chase Mode* with precision half-speed physics along an interconnected 3D pipe lattice:

- DIMENSIONAL FOLDING: Watch the 2D pipe net hinge 90° along its seams into a 3D cube (edge_fold.wav).
- 4 MANIFOLD KEYS: Locate and grab all four golden pressure keys (edge_key.wav) across the six cube faces.
- FACE TRANSITIONS: Crossing an outer seam rotates the camera gravity vector onto the adjacent cube face!

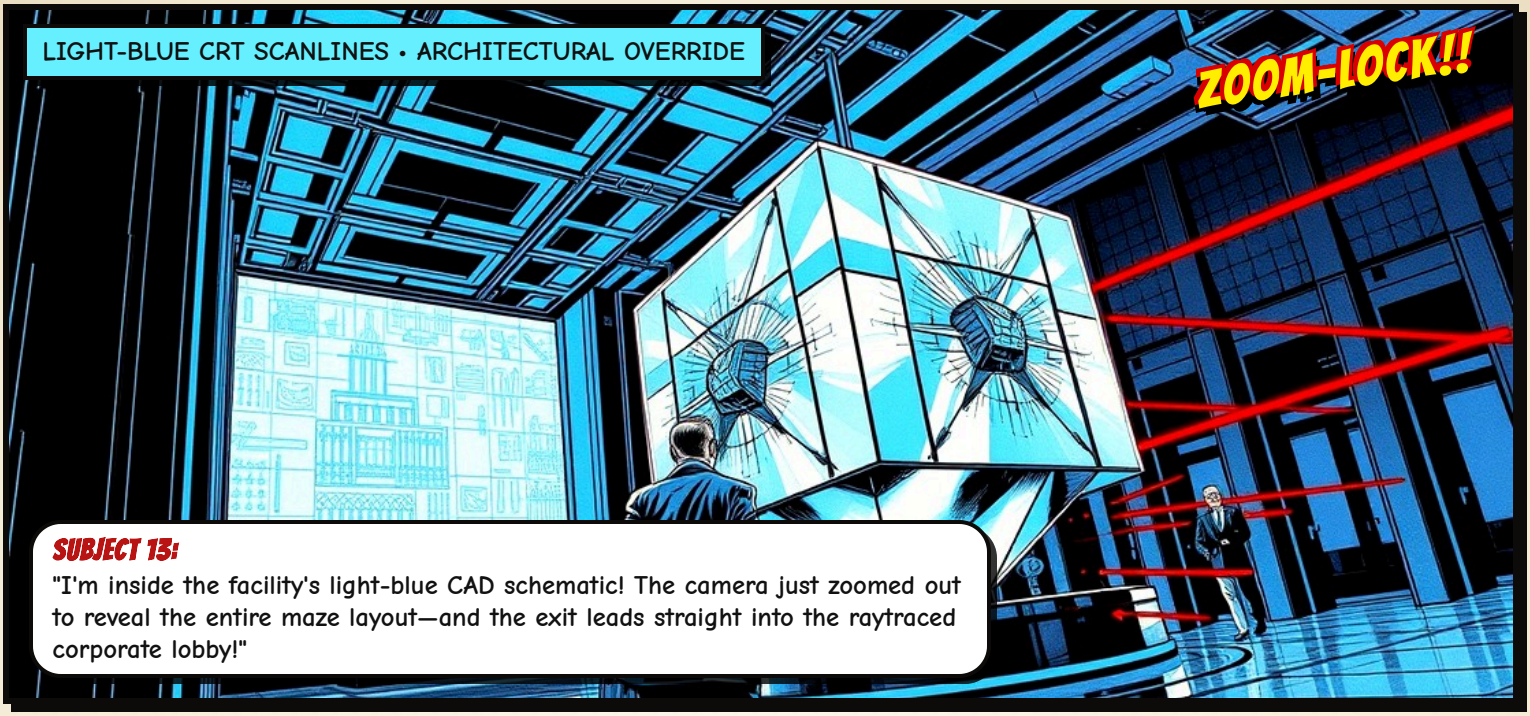
ALL 4 KEYS ACQUIRED! The central exhaust lock disengages, dropping Subject 13 straight into the facility's master architectural CAD blueprint!

MODE 08: EDGE MODE
EdgeState (3D Pipe Hypercube)

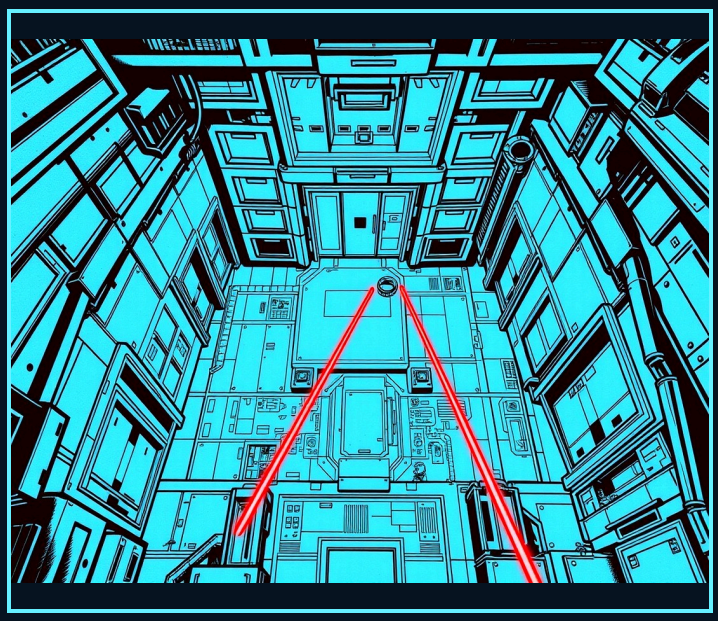
CORE MECHANICS
2D-to-3D cube folding, half-speed pipe traversal, chunked spatial culling, and 4-key collection.

AUDIO CUES
edge_fold / edge_key / edge_win

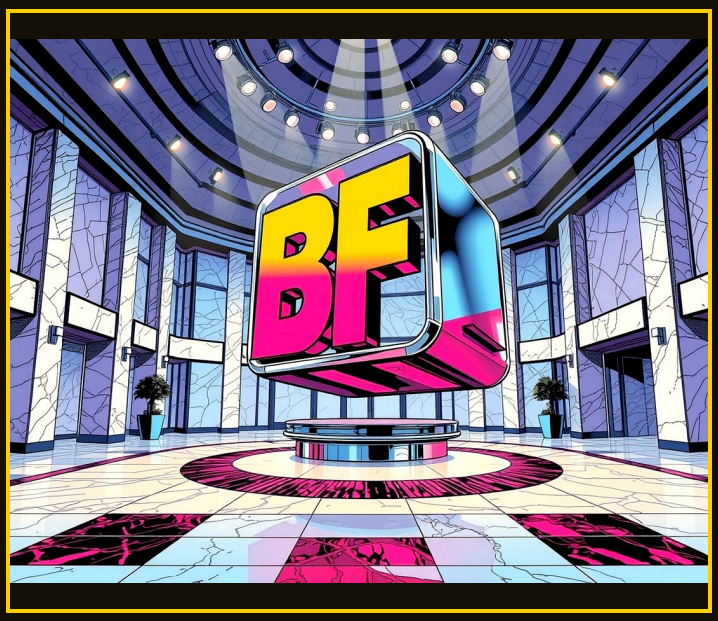
LIGHT-BLUE CRT SCANLINES • ARCHITECTURAL OVERRIDE



SUBJECT 13:
"I'm inside the facility's light-blue CAD schematic! The camera just zoomed out to reveal the entire maze layout—and the exit leads straight into the raytraced corporate lobby!"



[PHASE 1: CAD SCHEMATIC MAZE]
Smooth camera zoom-out overview (+0.5s tactical hold) with middle-wall elevation framing and light-blue phosphor CRT scanlines. Navigate the blueprint corridors to breach the surface level!



[PHASE 2: 20s 3D RAYTRACED LOBBY TOUR]
Upon clearing the schematic, the engine launches a 20-second 3D raytraced tour through the Buck-Fifty reception lobby past the 0.85-reflection chrome "BF" monolith toward the front doors!

MODE 09: BLUEPRINT MODE
BlueprintState (2D CAD + 3D Lobby)

CORE MECHANICS
Camera zoom-out overview (+0.5s hold), schematic maze navigation, and 20s 3D raytraced lobby transition.

NEXT ENCOUNTER
Lobby Airlock Security Breach





SECURITY BREACH QUIZ • EXTRACTION CODES

At the end of *Blueprint Mode* (or standalone in PizzaQuiz), the Bella Rosa messenger is your only ticket past Guard Station Delta's blast doors:

> **WINNING ORDERS:** Ask for a load-bearing crust supporting 165 pounds in the passenger seat, swap the thermal pouch for a duffel bag, or hide in the delivery hatchback's footwell!

> **DO NOT ORDER:** Pretentious Fibonacci olive spirals or non-Newtonian pesto—he'll leave you at the security desk!

AIRLOCK BREACHED! Smuggled past the reception desk inside the steaming pepperoni bag, Subject 13 spills out into the Sub-Level 3 Parking Garage!

MODE 10: PIZZA GUY QUIZ
Blueprint Security Breach / PizzaQuiz

INTERROGATION STRATEGY
Bribe the disgruntled Bella Rosa courier to smuggle you out to the subterranean parking lot.

UNLOCKED TV BREAK
tv_break_pizza_guy.mp4

SUB-LEVEL 3 PARKING GARAGE • RETRO RPG HALLUCINATION FOG!



SUBJECT 13:
"The dry-ice vents are turning the parking garage into a campy 16-bit fantasy RPG! A clunky Tin-Can Knight with a foam mallet is blocking the ramp to the Pizza Car!"



[PHASE 1: 23s TOP-DOWN CONE EVASION]
Sprint across the concrete bays dodging orange security cones, parked executive sedans, and wandering researcher Dr. Aris (who still thinks he's looking for his lost beagle).

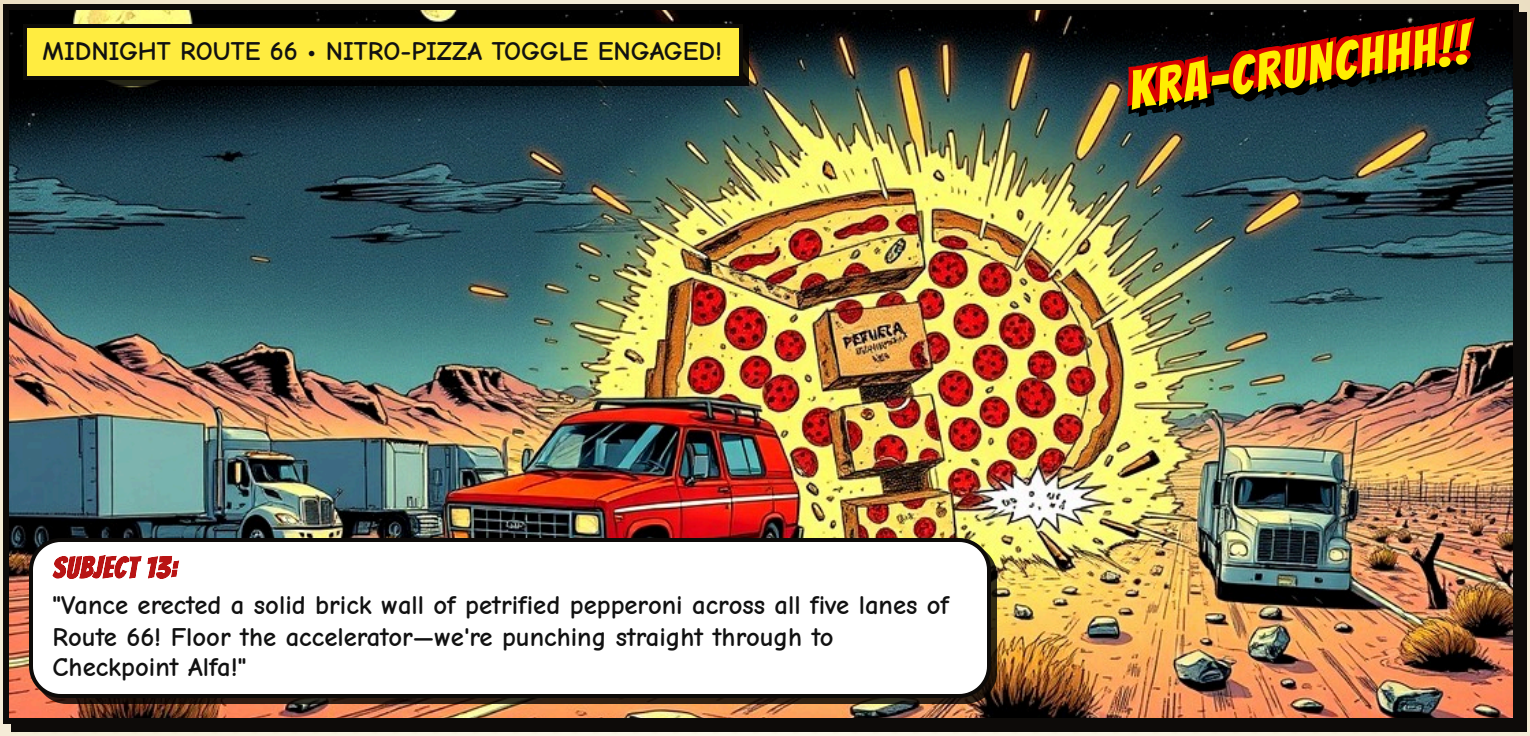


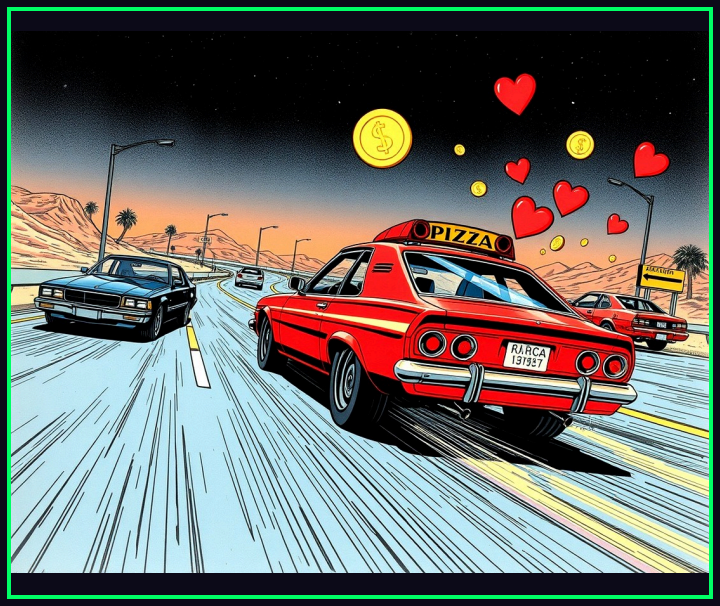
[PHASE 2: 16-BIT FANTASY PALETTE SHIFT & ZOOM OUTRO]
As the lavender mist thickens, the palette shifts into a whimsical 16-bit medieval RPG complete with tin-plated LARP knights and foam mallets! Reach the red PIZZA-ONE hatchback to trigger the Mode-7 zoom outro!

MODE 11: PARKING LOT
ParkingLotState (23s Stealth Sprint)

CORE MECHANICS
Top-down stealth cone evasion, 16-bit fantasy RPG palette shift, and Mode-7 zoom outro into Pizza-One.

EXTRACTION VEHICLE
1989 "PIZZA-ONE" Hatchback





[5-LANE OUTRUN / MODE-7 HIGHWAY ENGINE]
Weave across 5 desert highway lanes at blistering speed, dodging oncoming traffic and roadside hazards while the rooftop pizza sign spins at 60 RPM!



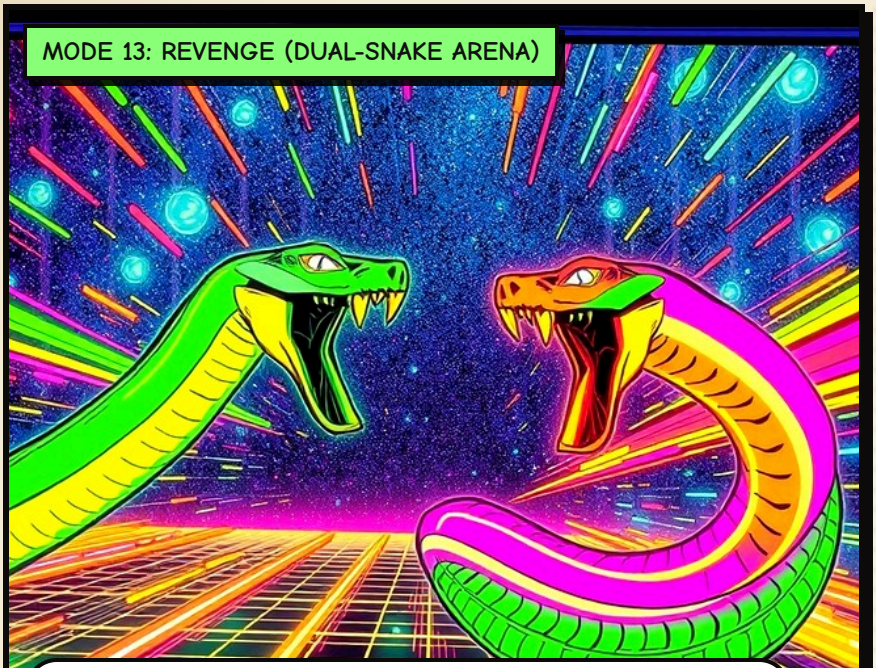
[THE PIZZA BRICK WALL IMPACT EVENT]
At the end of the highway sprint, PizzaDemoState culminates in the iconic Brick Wall collision (brick_break.wav, brick_crunch.wav)—shattering the simulation barrier!

MODE 12: PIZZA RACE
PizzaDemoState (5-Lane Highway Racer)

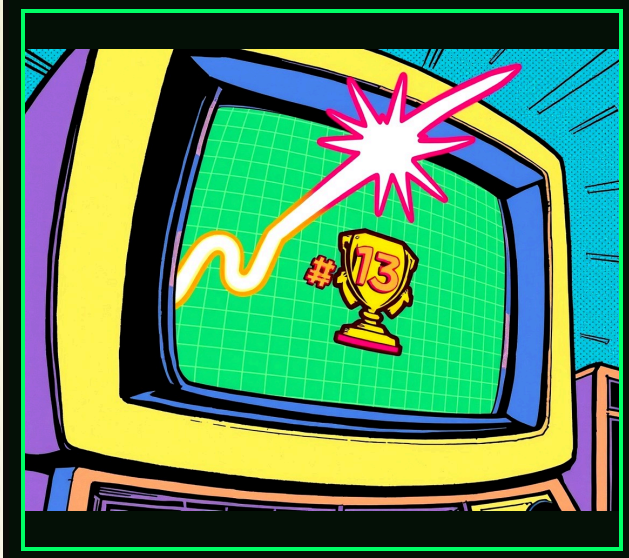
CORE MECHANICS
5-lane OutRun-style traffic dodging, roadside scaling, and the climactic Pizza Brick Wall impact event.

FINISH TRANSITION
Revenge Loop / Outro → WinState

MODE 13: REVENGE (DUAL-SNAKE ARENA)

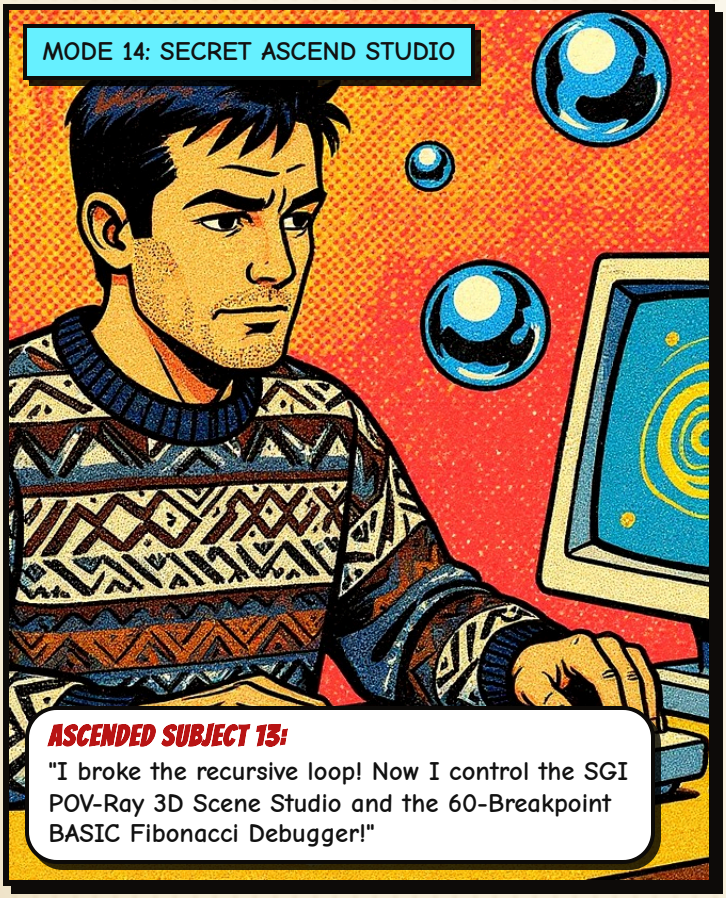


ARCADE TERMINAL 13:
"Visit #1 locks the monitor in monochrome Green Phosphor CRT against the AI Light-Serpent! Conquer Visit #2 and the whole arena ignites in full 1996 RGB color!"

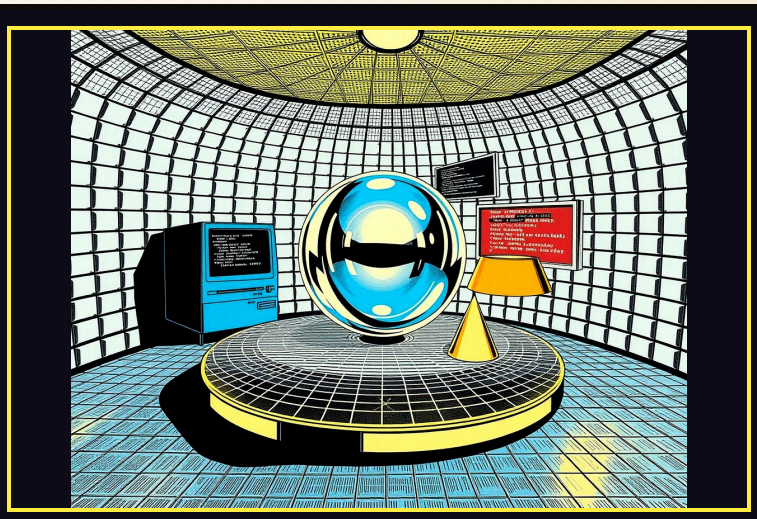


[CRT PHOSPHOR HARMONICS]
Even the yellow "13" badge on the HUD shifts into pure green phosphor on Visit #1 before restoring full RGB color on Visit #2!

MODE 14: SECRET ASCEND STUDIO



ASCENDED SUBJECT 13:
"I broke the recursive loop! Now I control the SGI POV-Ray 3D Scene Studio and the 60-Breakpoint BASIC Fibonacci Debugger!"



[ASCEND EDITOR & SPD MAGIC SCENE]
Unlocked after conquering the campaign, AscendEditorState grants full 3D primitive spawning, coloring, raytraced scene export, a live BASIC interpreter with 60 Fibonacci breakpoints, and the hidden SPD Magic Scene!

MODES 13 & 14: REVENGE & ASCEND	CORE MECHANICS	ULTIMATE REWARD
InterludeState + AscendEditorState	Green CRT & full-RGB arcade light-snake duels, plus full POV-Ray 3D Studio & BASIC Debugger.	SPD Magic Scene + $1.50 Per Diem





★ OFFICIAL BUCK-FIFTY 14-MODE CAMPAIGN & SURVIVAL CHECKLIST ★

#	GAME MODE / ENGINE STATE	PRIMARY CHALLENGE & SIGNATURE MECHANIC	PG
00	Boot / FMV / Main Menu	Seamless logo crossfade, campaign modes (Normal/SpeedRun/Permadeath), TV Breaks	02
01	Chase Mode (The Sphere)	Mode-7 ground chase, ChainEnemies, tower climbs, 38-spike Fibonacci Sphere Boss	03
02	Pre-Op Intake (Dr. Sterling)	Terminal interrogation outside Bay 04; spoof baseline for 90s cuff-override window	04
03	Surgery ("Just Let Go")	8 adventure verbs, 64 decoy tools, floating-letter phrase JUST LET GO (brain stays intact!)	05
04	Quarantine Triage Link	Amber-visor containment desk; tag corridor ping as phantom spaghetti telemetry	06
05	The Rise (Cooling Shaft)	Interactive CPU raytracer climbing falling polyominoes past tetrahedron watchers	07
06	The Labyrinth & Vertigo	1st-person emerald wireframe maze, cardiac ECG HUD, G-force stomach-flip spinout	08
07	Conduit Manifold (Pipe Tech)	Local 150 union valve terminal; log 3-key pressure relief & condensation purge	09
08	Edge Mode (Pipe Hypercube)	Half-speed 3D aluminum pipe network, 4 manifold keys, 2D-to-3D cube folding	10
09	Blueprint & Raytraced Lobby	Light-blue CAD schematic zoom-out (+0.5s hold) + 20s 3D raytraced lobby tour	11
10	Security Breach (Pizza Guy)	Bella Rosa courier bribe ($20 load-bearing crust / thermal pouch extraction)	12
11	Parking Lot Stealth	23s cone evasion, Dr. Aris's beagle, 16-bit RPG purple fog & Tin Knight, Mode-7 outro	13
12	Pizza Delivery Highway Race	5-lane midnight highway racer culminating in the Pizza Brick Wall impact	14
13-14	Revenge & Secret Ascend	Green CRT & RGB arcade light-snake duels + POV-Ray 3D Studio & BASIC Debugger	15

© 1996 BUCK-FIFTY INNOVATION LABS COMICS GROUP • PRINTED IN U.S.A.
SOUNDTRACK BY HOLON • 1-800-555-BUCK